



ILLUSTRATION BY RAJ VERMA

Yesterday was difficult, today is better. However, tomorrow should be the India of our dreams. If we were to envision the India of 2047, we would see ourselves as the second-largest economy in the world. India would be an upper-middle income country with per capita GDP of more than \$12,000. The states in the eastern part of the country would play a significant role in this growth journey. Basic amenities should be guaranteed to everyone. No one should go to sleep hungry. No life should be lost because of lack of access to or affordability of healthcare. The quality of life should see a significant uplift with India being ranked at par with the global best on key human development indices like happiness, life expectancy and access to education. This will need more public-private-partnerships in health and education

to touch all segments of society materially. The India of 2047 should be a leading voice and thought leader in the global arena and play a significant role in shaping the geopolitical order.

For India to achieve the goal of being a developed nation, we need to harness the full potential of our current demographic dividend. Today, India's gross enrollment ratio in higher secondary education is around 50 per cent. It means we are only unleashing half the potential of our youth; the other half is not being skilled through formal education. This needs to change significantly. Mere efficient utilisation of natural resources through cheap labour will not be sufficient. Pioneering a knowledge economy—a system of consumption and production that is based on intellectual capital—is the need for a better tomorrow.

The knowledge economy can be a huge enabler going forward to drive growth.

The economy of 2047 would be more balanced with a higher share of manufacturing. India should have attained leadership in key segments like renewable energy, electronics, chemicals, textiles, automotive and pharmaceuticals. India should lead the way through a focus on high quality and application of cutting-edge technology and design. While we think of national-level goals and enablers, it is also important for the mining and metals industry to achieve its true potential. The steel industry in India today largely caters to the growing domestic market. Despite having the key raw materials required for steelmaking, we are not one of the top exporters of steel and related downstream products. China, Japan and South Korea are the top exporters of steel globally despite having raw material disadvantages. This is an opportunity which we could capitalise on. We need to also work towards breakthroughs in sustainability practices. We have an opportunity to not only grow but to lead the green transition.

We have had some unique challenges throughout our history but have always overcome them and thrived. We have displayed unparalleled tenacity and resilience. We have done this consistently despite our incredible diversity of culture, language and geography. In fact, these have been our strengths and there is a bond of "Indianness" that binds us together. We have exhibited this for the past 75 years with success, and we will continue to do so. A vibrant democracy is what makes India. This is what will build the India we wish to see at 100. **BT**

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